

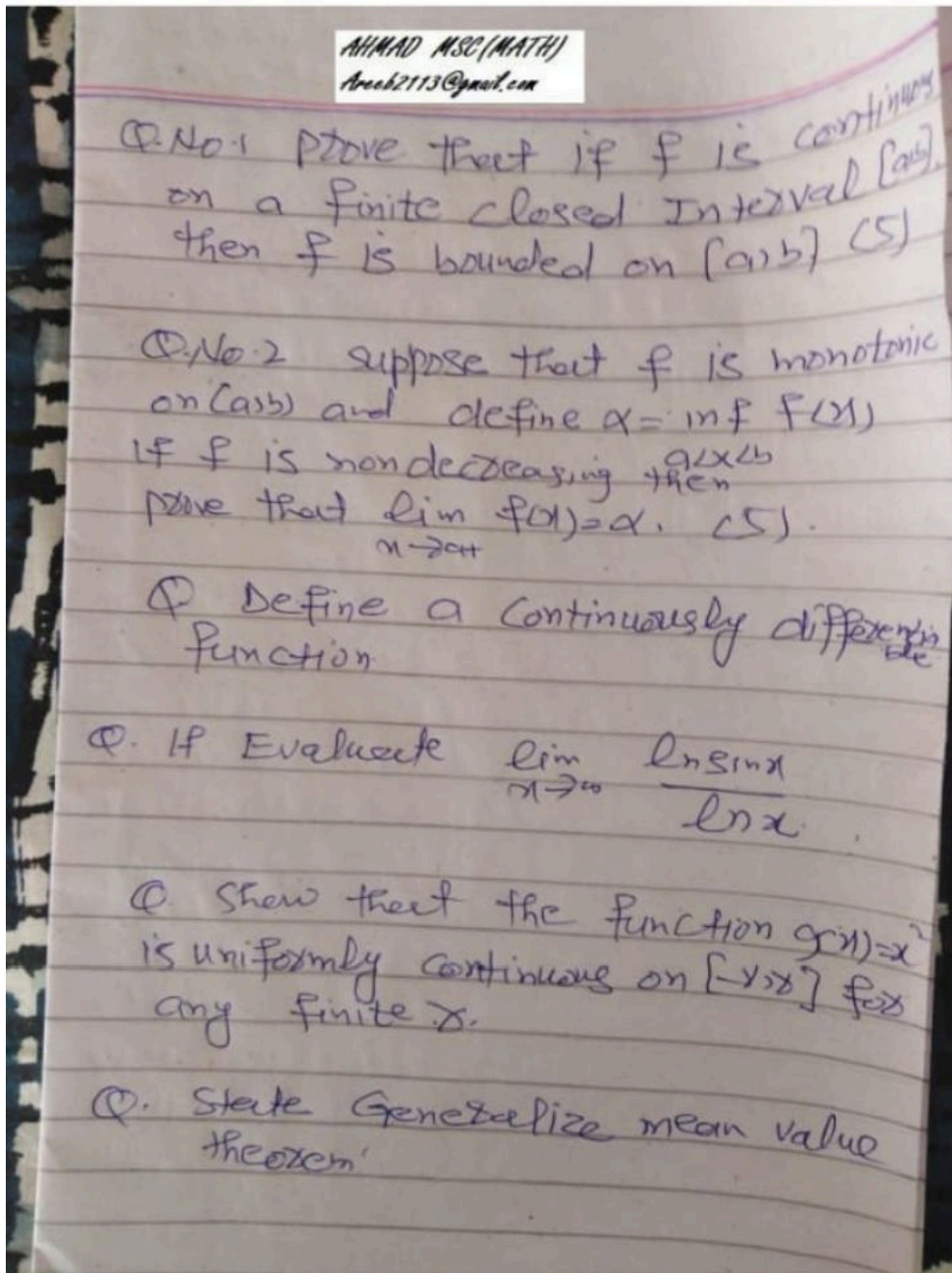
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Theorem: If f is continuous on a finite closed interval $[a, b]$, then f is bounded on $[a, b]$.

Proof: Suppose that $t \in [a, b]$. Since f is continuous at t , there is an open interval I_t containing t such that

$$|f(x) - f(t)| < 1 \quad \text{if} \quad x \in I_t \cap [a, b].$$

The collection $\mathcal{H} = \{I_t : a \leq t \leq b\}$ is an open covering of $[a, b]$.

Since $[a, b]$ is compact, the Heine-Borel theorem implies that there are finitely many points $t_1, t_2, \dots, t_n$ such that the intervals $I_{t_1}, I_{t_2}, \dots, I_{t_n}$ cover $[a, b]$.

According to continuity of the function and with $t = t_i$,

$$|f(x) - f(t_i)| < 1 \quad \text{if} \quad x \in I_{t_i} \cap [a, b].$$

3.8. Bounded Functions

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Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} |f(x)| &= |(f(x) - f(t_i)) + f(t_i)| \leq |f(x) - f(t_i)| + |f(t_i)| \\ &\leq 1 + |f(t_i)| \quad \text{if} \quad x \in I_{t_i} \cap [a, b]. \end{aligned}$$

Let

$$M = 1 + \max_{1 \leq i \leq n} |f(t_i)|.$$

Since $[a, b] \subset \bigcup_{i=1}^n (I_{t_i} \cap [a, b])$, and we have $|f(x)| \leq M$ if $x \in [a, b]$.

Theorem: Suppose that f is monotonic on (a, b) and define

$$\alpha = \inf_{a < x < b} f(x) \quad \text{and} \quad \beta = \sup_{a < x < b} f(x).$$

1. If f is nondecreasing, then $\lim_{x \rightarrow a+} f(x) = \alpha$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow b-} f(x) = \beta$.
2. If f is nonincreasing, then $\lim_{x \rightarrow a+} f(x) = \beta$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow b-} f(x) = \alpha$. (Here $a+ = -\infty$ if $a = -\infty$ and $b- = \infty$ if $b = \infty$.)

3.12. Limits Inferior and Superior

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3. If $a < x_0 < b$, then $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0+} f(x)$ and $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0-} f(x)$ exist and are finite; moreover,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0-} f(x) \leq f(x_0) \leq \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0+} f(x)$$

if f is nondecreasing, and

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0-} f(x) \geq f(x_0) \geq \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0+} f(x)$$

if f is nonincreasing.

Proof: We first show that $\lim_{x \rightarrow a+} f(x) = \alpha$.

If $M > \alpha$, there is an x_0 in (a, b) such that $f(x_0) < M$. Since f is nondecreasing, $f(x) < M$ if $a < x < x_0$. Therefore, if $\alpha = -\infty$, then $\lim_{x \rightarrow a+} f(x) = -\infty$.

If $\alpha > -\infty$, let $M = \alpha + \varepsilon$, where $\varepsilon > 0$.

Then $\alpha \leq f(x) < \alpha + \varepsilon$, so

$$|f(x) - \alpha| < \varepsilon \quad \text{if} \quad a < x < x_0. \quad (3.14)$$

If $a = -\infty$, this implies that $f(-\infty) = \alpha$. If $a > -\infty$, let $\delta = x_0 - a$. Then (3.14) is equivalent to

$$|f(x) - \alpha| < \varepsilon \quad \text{if} \quad a < x < a + \delta,$$

which implies that $f(a+) = \alpha$.

We now show that $\lim_{x \rightarrow b-} f(x) = \beta$.

If $M < \beta$, there is an x_0 in (a, b) such that $f(x_0) > M$.

Since f is nondecreasing, $f(x) > M$ if $x_0 < x < b$. Therefore, if $\beta = \infty$, then $\lim_{x \rightarrow b-} f(x) = \infty$.

If $\beta < \infty$, let $M = \beta - \varepsilon$, where $\varepsilon > 0$. Then $\beta - \varepsilon < f(x) \leq \beta$, so

$$|f(x) - \beta| < \varepsilon \quad \text{if} \quad x_0 < x < b. \quad (3.15)$$

If $b = \infty$, this implies that $f(\infty) = \beta$. If $b < \infty$, let $\delta = b - x_0$.

Then (3.15) is equivalent to

$$|f(x) - \beta| < \varepsilon \quad \text{if} \quad b - \delta < x < b,$$

which implies that $f(b-) = \beta$.

Q3

Continuously differentiable We say that f is *continuously differentiable* on $[a, b]$ if f is differentiable on $[a, b]$, f' is continuous on (a, b) ,

$$f'_+(a) = \lim_{x \rightarrow a+} f'(x)$$

, and

$$f'_-(b) = \lim_{x \rightarrow b-} f'(x).$$

Q5

Example: Show that the function $g(x) = x^2$ is uniformly continuous on $[-r, r]$ for any finite r .

Solution: To see this, note that

$$|g(x) - g(x')| = |x^2 - (x')^2| = |x - x'| |x + x'| \leq 2r|x - x'|,$$

so

$$|g(x) - g(x')| < \varepsilon \quad \text{if} \quad |x - x'| < \delta = \frac{\varepsilon}{2r} \quad \text{and} \quad -r \leq x, x' \leq r.$$

Q6

4.7 Generalized Mean Value Theorem

Theorem: If f and g are continuous on the closed interval $[a, b]$ and differentiable on the open interval (a, b) , then

$$[g(b) - g(a)]f'(c) = [f(b) - f(a)]g'(c)$$

for some c in (a, b) .

Proof: The function